

Refund Exception Handling Guide

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Process overview

Refund exceptions are handled separately from standard refund requests because they may involve missing evidence, customer-impacting delay, disputed service status, or override approval. This guide supports first-pass operations handling only.

Coordinators should avoid making final approval statements. The expected role is to collect the right context, classify the exception reason, and route the request to the correct owner.

Exception categories

Category	Typical Signal	Routing Note
Evidence missing	Invoice, activity log, or approval trail not attached	Refer to requestor for missing support.
Service status dispute	Customer states service was not active or incorrectly billed	Route to billing review owner.
Policy override	Refund falls outside standard window	Supervisor review required.
Duplicate charge claim	Two similar payment entries reported	Finance ops validation required.
Manual goodwill request	Business team requests exception for relationship	Discretionary approval required.

Minimum information required

- Customer/account identifier in sanitized form.
- Refund amount or range.
- Invoice or transaction reference.
- Reason for exception.
- Evidence attached or clear explanation for missing evidence.
- Business owner or requestor name.

Structured summary expected

Every exception should include a short internal summary before it is routed. The summary must state the exception type, evidence status, likely owner, and whether the request appears within standard policy or requires approval.

Escalation and review boundary

- Do not promise refund approval in the note.
- Do not infer customer intent beyond the provided evidence.
- Escalate to supervisor when policy window or amount threshold is unclear.
- Flag contradictory evidence rather than choosing one version.